



“AUTONOMOUS DRIVING TECH Is A Binary Problem, Solving 99.9 Percent Means That The Problem Has Not Been Solved”

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Autonomous driving, commonly referred to as self-driving tech, is not a new concept at all. Though it might have started gaining traction in India during the last couple of years, deep tech has been in focus for a lot of companies and institutions for more than two decades now. This is also probably a feature that adds a USP to the vehicles sold by Tesla and other electric vehicle brands all over the world. We at Electronics For You Network got in touch with a man who has dedicated his life to the development of cybernetics and autonomous driving tech.

On the board of various startups into robotics, drones, and self-driving, Dr Rahul Kala is also associated with Indian Institute of Information Technology, Allahabad. He is of the view that conducting research on self-driving tech in India is undertaking research that is not done anywhere else in the world.

In his words, “Autonomous tech is a binary problem and solving 99.9 percent means that the problem has not been solved.” Here is his take on autonomous tech keeping India in consideration as conveyed to Mukul Yudhveer Singh

What are your views on the current rate of adoption of autonomous vehicles in India?

In terms of the technology as well as the transportation system, we have two quite different India's. The first one is the national highways that we have and the second one is the city roads where things are extremely chaotic. When you see the first image of India, you can easily relate it to the conditions in Europe and the USA. Lane discipline, people sticking to traffic rules, and a lot of other things resonate between India, Europe, and the USA.

I see a very rapid adoption in the first case as this is where the accidents in India get extremely fatal. Introducing autonomous driving tech in the second India might get extreme as there is generally no lane following discipline there. Motorbikes, three-wheelers, and even pedestrians can pop out in front of vehicles within a matter of milliseconds.

The behaviour of vehicles and people in the second case negates all the principles that automated driving works upon. This negates safe driving principles. Here you will witness close

passing and cutting across of vehicles, which by the way is quite a common scenario. The case two also negates that there is a vehicle that you can follow. Lane keeping is one of the biggest principles of autonomous driving and in case two there exists no such principle in the minds of people in Indian cities.

If you are not talking about lane keeping as an elementary approach of autonomous driving, then you are talking about starting research that is not being pursued anywhere else in the world. Like a city in Prayagraj, where I hail from, will I ever be able to enjoy the